insolvency and bankruptcy code, and Modi's second term would move forward with greater reforms to achieve its goal of a US$ 5 trillion economy by 2024.

A fourth, more nuanced view is that the NDA is essentially a continuation of the UPA's economic model, with better branding and marketing. As former deputy chairman of Planning Commission, Montek Singh Ahluwalia, told me, 'As far as programmes are concerned, the NDA has more or less maintained most of the earlier programmes of UPA, though many of them have been renamed and modified in some ways. The question to ask is whether they are being better implemented. This calls for credible independent evaluation. GST is an important tax reform which was actually put on the agenda by the UPA, but opposed at that time by the BJP-ruled states. It is good that the Constitution was amended to enable GST, but I feel the design of the GST has got mangled with far too many rates and heavy compliance obligations on smaller firms. Demonetisation is called a reform, but in my view, it was a negative development which imposed a huge and unnecessary burden on the informal sector. The insolvency and bankruptcy code is a very important reform. I hope it proves to be a success. There are some areas where the NDA government has actually reversed the reform process. The decision to raise import duties, with the possibility of further increases ahead, is a major reversal of the policy of gradually reducing import duties, which has been in place for thirty years and was followed by several governments, including the Vajpayee government. It is not consistent with the objective of improving export performance and joining global value chains.'[39]

The big question to ask is whether there is, in fact, a BJP model of economics. Is there one common thread that binds Narendra Modi, Atal Bihari Vajpayee and other BJP-ruled states as part of a coherent economic vision? Or are they all different regimes driven by leaders with differing personalities and economic priorities? Modi came to power with the image of an economic reformer and his record on that has been mixed, but is there a thread binding his economic ideas with that of other BJP leaders in power?

The answer is yes. Despite falling growth in the Modi years and job creation that is way below what is needed, one reason why the